



December 2006

It's All Good

Yesterday, I got my gift that was due for over two months; I also got the December issue of *Digit*. Wow! It's simply superb! You guys rock. What an amazing mag! I could never expect more!

How can you guys manage to give away so many goodies at such a nominal price? I have heard people writing about the cost being too much, but just calculate—and you can't imagine! How can you all put up such a mind-blowing issue in just one month?? A 210-page magazine—I think it's worth 500 bucks, if not more!

I liked Agent001 this time the best. But one thing—I have my pre-board exams going on. And your magazine has kept me so busy these days—I think I may just keep myself from giving the exam or fail miserably! I just can't take my eyes off the magazine for a moment—and the only remedy that I see is to burn it (*you know I can't*)! Thanks for such a wonderful issue, and last but not least—the new interface is too cool! Fantastic visual appeal and user-friendliness.

Keep up the good work, guys.

Arkadyuti Mukherjee

Dear Arkadyuti,
We worked hard on the December issue, and we're glad to see—from letters like yours—that our efforts have paid off. We also worked very hard on the disc interface—thanks for the compliments! Passionate appreciation is most welcome!

— Executive Editor

Mr Disgruntled

Although I am not a subscriber of *Digit*, I have gone through almost all your issues, and for the last four months, I've been a regular reader. I would like to remind you that your magazine is very high-priced. Rs 125 or 200 for a

common man like me is not a joke. However, that wouldn't have been a problem if your magazine were informative enough. But looking into it, it's obvious that you are not keen on educating your readers through the newer trends; you are only eager to earn more revenue through advertising.

Look into the December issue. Out of 210 pages, well above 40 per cent—exactly 84 pages—are full of advertisements. I think your readers are fools (including me, I accept) to pay that much for only advertisements. And what about the other pages? Except three to four articles, like Agent 001, Q & A, Tips & Tricks, etc., the others are about gadgets... through which you earn heavily.

Again, regarding your CDs... where's the useful stuff? What will we do with shareware? I find nothing of value. If I'm paying you, I should only get freeware...

I thought I'd write an essay, but I'm fed up. I know you will never publish this letter.

Saji Paul

Dear Saji,
We appreciate constructive criticism, but we cannot agree with all your points. For one thing, ads are the lifeline of many a magazine. You've mentioned that 84 out of 210 pages are ads; and if you don't look at the ads at all, why not just think of it as a 126-page issue? What about everything we've packed into those 126 pages? As for many articles being about gadgets, we write about stuff that interests our readers—you obviously aren't a typical reader! And how do we "earn heavily" by featuring gadgets?

Regarding the disc contents, first off, we do provide lots of freeware. Secondly, you are not paying for software when you buy an issue—the shareware is there for you to try out. We're saving you download time and possibly money (if you pay by the hour for your connection). If you like the shareware, buy it—what we're doing is, we're making it available for your perusal. In any case, we're sorry to have disappointed you.

— Executive Editor

At Your Service—Always

I am a student of class VIII, and though I do not have a *Digit* subscription, I haven't missed a single issue since last year. You people are sure a doing an awesome job. The December issue was fantastic, and so was the *Fast Track*. The Tips & Tricks, Beat That, Gender

Benders, and Digipick make the magazine even better. I really wish you could turn *Digit* into a weekly magazine.

Software like Corel Office, Google Desktop, Autopatcher, and the *Digit* Archive CD was *reaaaally* great. One more thing: I was really eager to try out *Need for Speed: Carbon*. I found it in your December issue, but the DVD was corrupted. Could you help me?

Shameek Sarkar
Kolkata

Dear Shameek,

Our customer service helpdesk is always at your service. Unless you've already done so, just call or write in, and you'll get a replacement immediately!

— Executive Editor

The Many Faces Of Tech

Your lead article *You're Being Watched* is timely. The article throws light on the psyche of voyeuristic minds, and the interview aptly sums up the working of voyeurs at large. The advent of round-the-clock news channels added a whole new ugly dimension to this episode. Not only individuals but also the media has a share in spreading this perverted attitude.

Going by the recent trends on news channels—sting operations, MMS scandals—it seems they have buried the ethos. The private life of citizens is being snuffed out by this obtrusive attitude of the media. Private life is publicised and sensationalised. "Bug and make bucks," that's the current mantra.

Hi-tech gadgets, faster processors, larger bandwidths, gigabytes of memory to digitize every bit of our lives, uploading, downloading and sharing content is now possible with a single touch of a button.

Proud, yes, but I am worried at the same time. Who knows—one day you may end up on a big show (read reality show at its worst) à la Jim Carrey in *The Truman Show*.

My intention is not to paint a grim picture—all I want to say is we need technology to make this world a better place to live in, but on the other hand, it's the collective responsibility of individuals to see to it that this happens. It's not the technology that is bad—it's the mind that perverts it.

A Happy New Year to Team Digit!

Dr I Sai Krishna
Hyderabad